

The Nintendo Wii, of course, is the exception to this rule. If your video game console is going to double up as a multimedia entertainment device, then the Wii goes out of the equation immediately.

While the PS3 and the Xbox 360 both offer various options, Sony wins this battle hands-down for various reasons.

First of all, the Blu-Ray drive. You are getting a future-proof optical disk drive with the PS3 and once the format becomes popular, you will not even have to spend anything extra to buy a Blu-Ray player.

Second, the PS3's previously mentioned upscaling ability. Watching video on a computer screen and watching it on a TV are two very different processes, and the fact that the PS3 makes good use of its RSX graphics unit to enhance the picture quality goes a long way in our book. If it seems like we are making a mountain out of a mole hill, trust us that the upscaling of the device has to be seen to be believed.

Lastly, the PS3's base Linux system lends it towards using and playing back various audio and video formats. The lack of DivX support on the Xbox 360 has to be a clincher in favour of the PS3 for all movie lovers.

#### **2.6.4 FOR THOSE ON A BUDGET**

Sometimes, the only consideration while buying a video game console is the price. The Wii, Xbox 360 and PlayStation 3 are all platforms that you will enjoy gaming on, but you are on a budget at the moment, so the damage to your wallet is the prime concern.

In India, the Xbox 360 is still the least expensive proposition of the three. The Nintendo Wii officially sells at around Rs. 22,000 in electronics retail stores, and each game costing between Rs. 2,250 and Rs. 3,000. Even with conservative estimates for buying a title a month, that's an annual expenditure of Rs. 49,000 – Rs. 9,000 more than our previous estimate for the Xbox 360.

Plus, the support available for the 360 is far superior to that of the Wii or the PS3, thus making it the obvious choice.

#### **2.6.5 FOR THE PIRATES**

Given our job profile, we are often asked by friends and family as to which console to buy. The second question is always: "And does it play pirated games?"

Piracy is big in India, and while we don't condone it, we cannot ignore one of the largest parameters in the buying decision.

For pirates, the question of the PlayStation 3 is moot as the game has not been cracked and cannot play copied disks.

The Xbox 360 and the Nintendo Wii have both been worked over by crackers and are fully compatible with all the thousands of bootlegged DVDs you find in the grey market.

The big question here is reliability. When you crack a console to play pirated games on it, you are voiding the warranty.